

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 944

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the United States women's hockey team on winning the gold medal at the 2026 Olympic Games.

WHEREAS, the United States women's hockey team has brought great pride and joy to Americans from all walks of life by emerging victorious from the 2026 Olympic Games as gold medalists and world champions; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. team defeated archrival Canada in overtime in the final match to claim our nation's third gold medal in women's hockey and its first since 2018; and

WHEREAS, dominant in its first six matches at the 2026 Olympic Games, the U.S. squad was unbeaten and unchallenged heading into the gold medal tilt, having outscored its opponents by 30 goals in winning six consecutive games; and

WHEREAS, after conceding one goal in the Olympic opener, the U.S. team did not allow a single goal in its five games leading up to the final, setting a new Olympic record for holding opponents scoreless at 331 minutes and 23 seconds; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. women's hockey team steamrolled Czechia 5-1, Finland 5-0, Switzerland 5-0, and Canada 5-0 in the preliminary matches of the tournament to advance to the first knockout round; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. team then blitzed Italy 6-0 in the quarterfinals and routed Sweden 5-0 in the semifinals to earn a berth in the gold medal match; and

WHEREAS, despite having won seven consecutive games against archrival Canada, including a 5-0 thrashing in the 2026 Olympic preliminary round, the U.S.'s unstoppable offense was stymied during the first 58 minutes of the gold medal match, as Canada's defense stonewalled the Stars and Stripes; and

WHEREAS, with two minutes remaining in regulation time, Hilary Knight, the U.S. captain playing in her fifth and final Olympic Games, deflected a shot by teammate Laila Edwards into Canada's goal to give her team new life and send the final match into sudden-death overtime; and

WHEREAS, three minutes into overtime, U.S. alternate captain Megan Keller pushed the puck past the Canadian goaltender to earn the 2-1 victory, win the Olympic gold medal, and claim the title of world champion; and

WHEREAS, each of the U.S. women's hockey players contributed significantly to the dominant, record-setting success of the team; in addition to the aforementioned players, the U.S. roster included Gwyneth Philips, Aerin Frankel, Grace Zumwinkle, Kelly Pannek, Lee Stecklein, alternate captain Alex Carpenter, Kendall Coyne Schofield, Cayla Barnes, Abbey Murphy, Hayley Scamurra, Ava McNaughton, Hannah Bilka, Tessa Janecke, Caroline Harvey, Taylor Heise, Rory Guldlay, Joy Dunne, Britta Curl-Salemme, Haley Winn, and Kirsten Simms; and

WHEREAS, the 2026 U.S. Olympic women's hockey team enjoyed outstanding leadership on the bench, including head coach John Wroblewski; assistant coaches, Josh Sciba, Brent Hill, and Shari Dickerman; and goaltending coach, Alli Altmann; and

WHEREAS, Olympic gold medals are won through hard work, dedication, commitment to working together as a team, and a cooperative spirit; the U.S. women's hockey team exhibited each of these rare qualities during the 2026 Games; and

WHEREAS, these proud Americans achieved the highest level of success on the ice while showing the highest degree of character both on and off the ice; and

WHEREAS, the dedication, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of athletes not only made possible the United States' third gold medal in women's hockey but also surely bode well for their success in every future endeavor; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the U.S. women's hockey players for winning an Olympic gold medal while representing their country with dignity and poise; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the players, coaches, and staff members of the United States women's hockey team on winning the gold medal at the 2026 Olympic Games, praising their performance on the ice as world champions and extending to them our best wishes for much continued success in their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.